

Dubai Creek Harbour Submarket Overview

Dubai Creek Harbour recorded 1,180 off-plan apartment transactions in H1 2026, up 21% year-on-year, as the district continues its build-out with several towers reaching handover over the past two years. The district remains earlier in its lifecycle than Dubai Marina, with a higher proportion of off-plan versus secondary-market transactions.

Average price per square foot for studio units in Dubai Creek Harbour reached approximately AED 1,950 in H1 2026, up from AED 1,760 a year earlier, reflecting continued investor interest in the district's waterfront positioning and proximity to the planned Creek Tower.

Studios represent the fastest-selling unit type in the district by absorption rate, with several launches in the past year selling out their studio allocation within weeks of release.

Rental Yield Analysis — Studio Units

Gross rental yields for studio units in Dubai Creek Harbour averaged 7.4% in H1 2026, among the highest of any major Dubai submarket, based on a sample of completed towers with at least 12 months of leasing history. Achieved annual rents for studios of 380-460 sqft ranged from AED 52,000 to AED 68,000.

After accounting for owners association service charges, which in completed Creek Harbour towers range from AED 14 to AED 19 per sqft per annum, net yields for studios typically fall between 6.0% and 6.9%, though this range assumes service charges remain within the disclosed estimate.

Investors should note that several completed towers in the district have seen service charge increases of 15-30% in their second year of operation as Owners Associations took over budgeting from developers, which is not reflected in the gross yield figures cited by developers at launch.

Comparable Projects

Two recently launched studio-heavy towers provide the closest comparables to Creek Horizon Tower: Harbour Point Residences (launched 2025, off-plan price/sqft AED 2,050) and Island Vista Tower (launched 2024, now under construction, off-plan price/sqft AED 1,890 at launch, currently reselling around AED 2,100).

Creek Horizon Tower's launch price of AED 2,000 per sqft sits between these two comparables, and its Q2 2029 handover date is later than both, reflecting its earlier construction stage (piling only, versus structural works underway at both comparables).

Both comparable projects disclosed initial service charge estimates in the AED 15-17 per sqft range at launch, broadly consistent with Creek Horizon Tower's AED 16 per sqft estimate, though as noted in the yield analysis, actual charges have trended higher after Owners Association handover in this district.

Infrastructure Catalysts

The Dubai Metro's Creek Harbour extension, connecting the district to the existing Green Line, is under construction with an expected opening in 2027, ahead of Creek Horizon Tower's anticipated handover — though as with any infrastructure project, timelines can shift and investors should not treat 2027 as guaranteed.

The long-delayed Creek Tower project, positioned as a signature landmark for the district, remains under review by the master developer as of Q2 2026, with no confirmed construction restart date; its eventual completion (or continued absence) is likely to influence district-wide sentiment and pricing.

The master developer's Central Park and waterfront boardwalk phases are under construction and partially open, with full completion of the public realm programme expected in phases through 2028.

Price Trend Forecast

Analysts project price-per-square-foot growth of 6-10% annually for Dubai Creek Harbour through 2028, reflecting the district's earlier stage in its build-out cycle relative to more established submarkets, though this also implies higher sensitivity to shifts in investor sentiment or delays to master-plan infrastructure.

Given the district's higher proportion of investor-held (versus end-user) stock, analysts flag a greater risk of concentrated resale supply hitting the market around common handover windows, which could temper near-term price appreciation for units completing in the same period as several other towers.

Long construction timelines and the prevalence of aggressive post-handover payment plans across the district mean investor returns are more sensitive to holding-period assumptions than in more mature submarkets; PropertyDoc recommends modelling both a base case and a delayed-handover scenario before committing capital.